ContractLens (Hackaton version)

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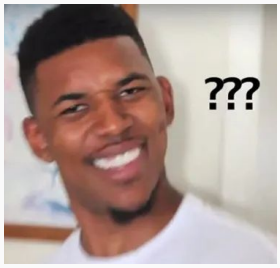
How hard can it be?

"TO THE MAXIMUM EXTENT PERMITTED BY APPLICABLE LAW, IN NO EVENT SHALL THE COMPANY, ITS AFFILIATES, DIRECTORS, EMPLOYEES, OR LICENSORS BE LIABLE FOR ANY DIRECT, INDIRECT, PUNITIVE, INCIDENTAL, SPECIAL, CONSEQUENTIAL, OR EXEMPLARY DAMAGES, INCLUDING WITHOUT LIMITATION DAMAGES FOR LOSS OF PROFITS, GOODWILL, USE, DATA, OR OTHER INTANGIBLE LOSSES, THAT RESULT FROM THE USE OF, OR INABILITY TO USE, THIS SERVICE, UNDER ANY THEORY OF LIABILITY, INCLUDING, WITHOUT LIMITATION, CONTRACT, TORT (INCLUDING NEGLIGENCE), STRICT LIABILITY, OR OTHERWISE, EVEN IF THE COMPANY HAS BEEN ADVISED OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE, AND NOTWITHSTANDING THE FAILURE OF ESSENTIAL PURPOSE OF ANY LIMITED REMEDY."



Here is a SINGLE sentence from a regular Software/Service License Agreement used by many companies such as Amazon, Sony, Apple. I like to read books but this single sentence is too loaded and I do not understand what it means. It says that the company is not liable for incidents, what about my warranty? What if I feel lied about the service?. Now this is a single sentence, user agreements are 20 pages long. All this information just to watch my favorite show on Prime Video.

What are my options?

Hire a lawyer

Do not pirate

Hiring a lawyer sounds expensive and ridiculous. When there are multiple services available that could make my life easier (music, movies, health, email, phone, etc), every single service would require any person to sign a user agreement. We do not want to get involve with pirating any kind of media. I do not want the feds destroying my door and eating my deserts.

What do we want

- Easy to understand plain language
- Highlight any line that would require caution
- Save all my agreements information to check later
- Save me money with experienced professionals

Remove all that talk about laws, professionals, entities and a multitud of different cases. I just want to subscribe and enjoy some content. But as well I want to be informed about any sneaky clause the a company is trying to hide from me. If I have a concern that I have not been careful enough, I want to check my past deals and plan what can I expect if I want to claim something is wrong with what I paid for.

Presenting ContractLens

Easy to understand and cheap

🚩 **Red Flags** 6

Mandatory Arbitration and Class Action Waiver HIGH

You are agreeing to resolve any disputes with Disney through binding individual arbitration, meaning you give up your right to sue in court or participate in a class-action lawsuit. This significantly limits your legal recourse, especially for widespread issues.

Unilateral Modification of Terms MEDIUM

Disney can change the terms of this agreement with 30 days' notice, either by email or by posting the changes on their services. If you don't agree with the changes, your only recourse is to stop using the services. This means you could be bound by new terms you haven't actively agreed to.

This is how we build this website and service called ContractLens. Now it is easy to understand with key red flags from an specific uploaded agreement. I can read in plain english what is important, I feel informed. And maybe, who knows, I was actually not wanting to be under such strict contract just to buy an apple, for example.

Continuing…

Educational

Reference Cases & Context 4

Similar Agreement **Netflix Terms of Service (Account Sharing)**

Netflix has faced scrutiny and user backlash over its policies regarding account sharing outside of a household. While this agreement also restricts sharing, the specifics and enforcement can vary, and user complaints often lead to policy adjustments or clearer guidelines.

Relevance: This agreement, like others for streaming services, has clauses about account sharing and household usage. Users should be aware that policies on this can evolve and sometimes lead to user dissatisfaction or changes in terms.

Similar Agreement **Spotify's Auto-Renewal and Cancellation Policies**

Many subscription services, including Spotify, have faced complaints about auto-renewal and the ease of cancellation. Users often find it difficult to cancel before being charged again. Disney+'s policy here is similar, requiring cancellation before the end of the billing period to avoid renewal.

Relevance: The auto-renewal and cancellation terms in the Disney+ agreement are common in the subscription service industry. Users often find these terms frustrating, and disputes can arise if cancellation is not straightforward or if refunds are denied.

With ContractLens, I can learn from past cases that look similar and stay clear from any of these services. I want to avoid them as much as anybody else.

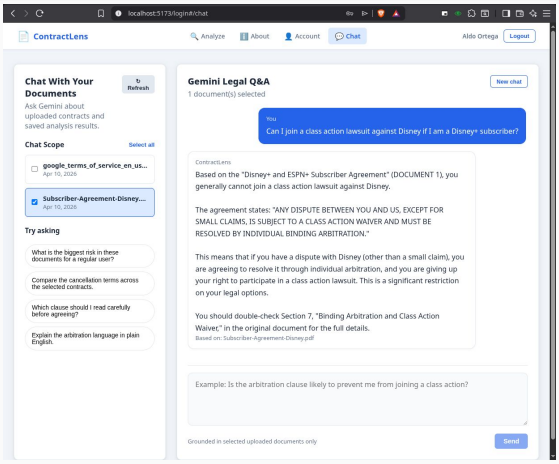
Continuing…

Saves data to review later

A history saved so I can reviewed for any mistake made when I signup for a service online. Nobody is perfect and we can all make mistakes in a rush to watch our favorite series.

Continuing…

Clarifications about specific matters



To make even easier. A chat which only see the selected agreement. You can ask anything about the agreement and make all your nightmares are not going to become real when signing to a faceless entity.

What is next?

- Browser Plugin: Make it easier. Who wants to do a search about every user agreement they come across.
- Share deployment: Keep your information to yourself.
- Editable default: Maybe we know what we want and we just want that.
- Personal assistant: Build a personalized agent with your past uploads and chat conversations.

We had so many plans for this project but the time constraint was a problem as well as other thing happening the day of the hackathon. Browser plugin would be great to just detect a user agreement and give a summary. Sharing the deployment would empowered anybody that want to use this amazing tool. Editable default to personalized your experience if you do not agree with our team decision for red flags and similarities from other companies. Personal assistant which could be trained with your history submits and chatting.